

THE END OF BEING FOOLED

Waking Up to What We've Built

— A POEM ABOUT AUTHENTICITY · AND THE WORLD THAT PUNISHES IT

BY TARUN GUPTA

I . ORIGIN

The Moment It Came From

Watching someone get torn apart for being real.

Watching the hollow ones get praised.

Not rage — clarity.



*Waking up to a realization
About how the world is changing
Thoughts driven by exteriority
No care about what lies within
People drooling over aesthetics
Shitting all over the hearts of the good ones
Praising the false gods
Demeaning deserving humans
Talking about love and life
Not knowing the true meaning
How our civilization has turned out
wearing layers of masks themselves
ready to tear down the true faces
Only to make themselves happy
Only to make themselves happy.*



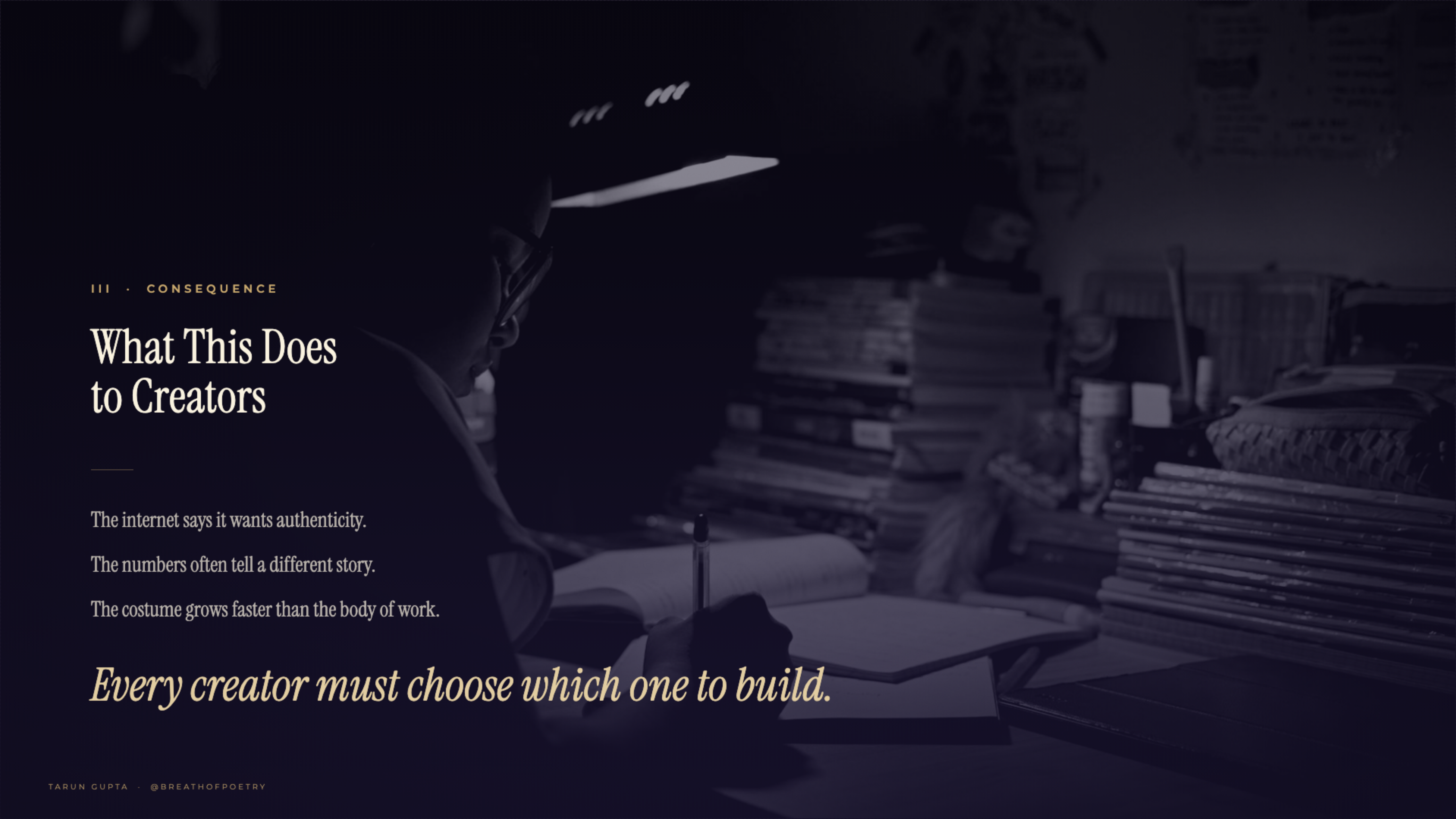
II · THE MECHANISM

The Mask Paradox

The masked aren't confident — they're defended.

Authenticity indicts performance.

The mask needs the real face to disappear.

A person wearing glasses is sitting at a desk, writing in a notebook with a pen. The room is cluttered with stacks of papers, books, and other items. The lighting is dim, with a bright light source visible in the background.

III · CONSEQUENCE

What This Does to Creators

The internet says it wants authenticity.

The numbers often tell a different story.

The costume grows faster than the body of work.

Every creator must choose which one to build.

IV · THE END OF BEING FOOLED

The Waking Up

The poem doesn't offer a fix.

It offers a name.

Naming ends the confusion.

*“The waking up in the first line
isn't despair. It's the end of being fooled.”*

TARUN GUPTA
